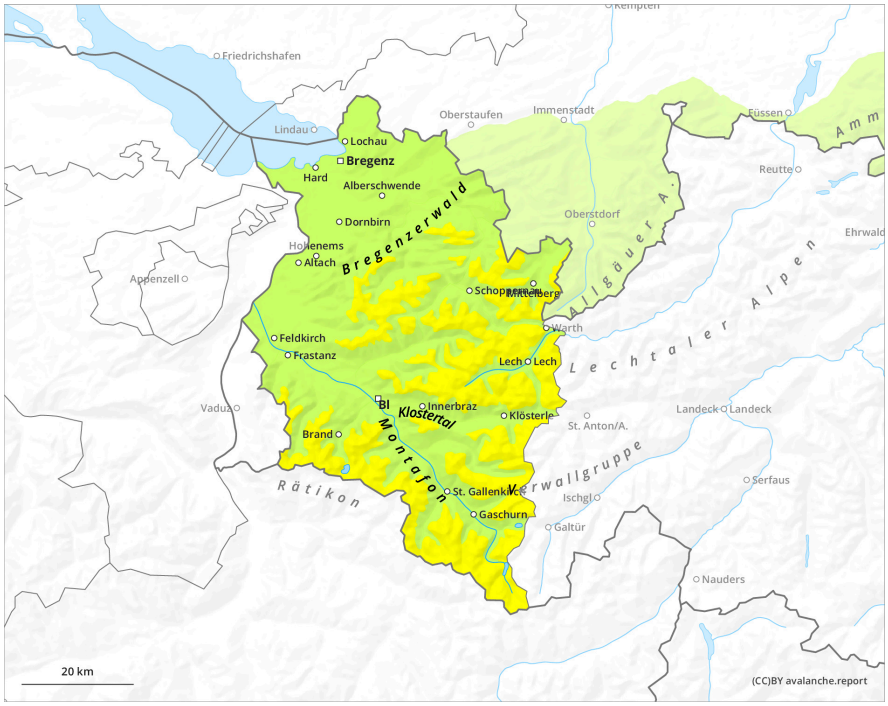
Saturday 14 March 2026

Published 13 Mar 2026, 17:00:00
Valid from 13 Mar 2026, 17:00:00 until 14 Mar 2026, 17:00:00
Written by Bernhard Anwander

Beware snowdrifts and weak layers on shady slopes



1	2	3	4	5
low	moderate	considerable	high	very high

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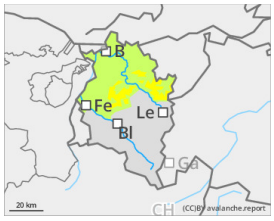
Danger Level 2 - Moderate



Tendency: Constant avalanche danger
on Sunday 15 March 2026

Wind slab

2000m

Beware snowdrifts on shady slopes

Fresh snow and fresh drifts lie often atop surface hoar on wind-protected, high-altitude shady slopes. Winter sports enthusiasts can trigger mostly small avalanches. Apart from the risks of being buried in snow masses, the danger of being swept along and forced to take a fall also requires due consideration.

Snowpack

Above about 1500m there was 10-15cm of fresh fallen snow registered on Thursday. Fresh snow and loosely-packed old snow will be transported by intensifying foehn winds until Saturday afternoon. Saturday morning, an additional 5-10cm of fresh snow will be delivered, on shady slopes often lying deposited atop surface hoar at all altitudes. The mid-level of the snowpack consists widespread of well settled, compact layers which on shady slopes at high altitudes are blanketed by a poorly structured old snowpack fundament. This weak layer is thus no longer to be triggered by persons.

Weather

On Saturday it will remain dry through most of the morning hours, accompanied by final foehn-generated bright intervals. Then skies will cloud over, before midday the first precipitation will begin, becoming heavier in the afternoon. Snowfall level will drop from 1500m down to 1000m by evening. Temperatures at 2000m: initially at 0 degrees, in the afternoon dropping successively down to -6 degrees by the end of the day; at 3000m: from -6 to -11 degrees. At high altitudes, initially brisk southwesterly winds, blowing at strong velocity in gusts, later shifting to northwesterly and blowing at moderate velocity.

Tendency

By Sunday, 15-25cm of fresh snowfall is anticipated. Accompanied by moderate winds, small snowdrift accumulations can be generated near ridgelines at higher altitudes.